

# Antifragile

— seven Books, three movements

---

## MOVEMENT I · THE PROPERTY

*What antifragility is — and how modernity smothers it.*

---

**01**

### The Antifragile: An Introduction

*Beyond resilience lies a property that feeds on disorder.*

**02**

### Modernity and the Denial of Antifragility

*Smooth stability is manufactured fragility.*

## MOVEMENT II · THE LOGIC

*Non-prediction, optionality, convexity — seeing and acting under uncertainty.*

---

**03**

### A Nonpredictive View of the World

*Don't predict the shock — detect the fragility.*

**04**

### Optionality, Technology & the Intelligence of Antifragility

*Hold the right, not the obligation — and tinker.*

**05**

### The Nonlinear and the Nonlinear

*Harm accelerates — big, fast, and leveraged things break.*

## MOVEMENT III · THE PRACTICE

*Via negativa and ethics — how to live, and who pays for fragility.*

---

**06**

### Via Negativa

*To improve, subtract; trust the old, remove the harmful.*

**07**

### The Ethics of Fragility and Antifragility

*Skin in the game is the only true cure for fragility.*

---

*“The resilient resists shocks and stays the same. The antifragile gets better.”*

# Detect → Position → Subtract

Run it on a portfolio, a career, a company, a body, a life. Pin it where decisions get made.

---

## DETECT

*Find the fragility before it finds you*

- 1. Asymmetry test**  
More downside than upside from a shock? Fragile.
- 2. Accelerating harm**  
If the 2nd unit hurts more, it's concave — fragile.
- 3. Turkey clock**  
A long quiet record is suspicious, not safe.
- 4. Size, speed, debt**  
The three reliable fragilizers — flag them.
- 5. Visible over hidden**  
The smooth risk is the one that ruins you.
- 6. Backward from ruin**  
Before anything, ask: is the worst case survivable?

## POSITION

*Set yourself up to gain from disorder*

- 1. Build a barbell**  
Mostly ultra-safe, a small slice ultra-bold.
- 2. Collect free options**  
Small known cost, large unknown upside.
- 3. Tinker**  
Many small reversible bets beat one big plan.
- 4. Earn a buffer**  
Slack lets you decline bad deals and survive.
- 5. Doers over narrators**  
Demonstrated competence beats eloquent theory.
- 6. Stay a flaneur**  
Revise your course as information arrives.

## SUBTRACT

*Remove what makes you brittle*

- 1. Lead with removal**  
Take away the harmful before adding the good.
- 2. Raise the hurdle**  
Treat the severe; leave the mild alone.
- 3. Lindy**  
Favor the time-tested; novelty is unproven.
- 4. Subtract misery**  
Remove what you know hurts first.
- 5. Skin in the game**  
Trust only those exposed to the downside.
- 6. Back your views**  
No personal risk, no real conviction.

---

*Everything big is short volatility. So is everything fast. The proof that you are alive is that you like variation.*